ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA : 3.64) in the Third Cycle)

KARAIKUDI

Date: 07.12.2017

The Inaugural Function of the International Conference on "Focus on Mindfulness: Glimpses of Neuroscience Education", organized by the Department of Physical Education and Health Sciences of Alagappa University, Karaikudi, was held on 7.12.2017 in the L.CT.L. Palaniappa Chettiar Memorial Auditorium.

Presiding over the function, Prof. S. Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor, Alagappa University, said that the human mind is like a moving camera, which could exactly replay the past and pre-play the future. But one should not think of the past unhappy events and also one should not worry too much about the future. One should live in the present for which meditation helps to a very large extent. A human being should learn to live peacefully and joyfully. For that, Neuroscience Education helps by reducing stress and developing inner peace. Emotional stability and social adjustability are two important keys for academic development and students should always keep this in mind. Giving exercise to the mind and body helps in improving the blood flow into the brain, thus decreasing the blood pressure, improving the mood and brain power. Mindfulness, in fact, makes one aware of what he is thinking and doing and helps him to be in the moment and also makes him respond more wisely to the situation. In this context, he said that Chris Evert, the famous tennis player, stated in an interview that she owed her victories to three reasons – a burning desire to win, treating the victory and failure with the same mental equilibrium and playing with techniques. "Achieving your goal will automatically give you happiness and that "happy drug" would automatically create a kind of elated mood in you", he added.

Prof. A.M. Moorthy, Former Vice-Chancellor, Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University, Chennai, in his Inaugural Address, highlighted how to create mindfulness through yoga. He discussed how yoga and meditation helps one to lead a peaceful life. "Yoga is the only way to clean the brain and to manage the stress caused by various situations of life", he stated emphatically.

Dr.K. Chandrasekaran, Professor and Head, Department of Physical Education, Madurai Kamaraj University, in his felicitation address, discussed the scientific base of yoga and said how the wonderful Indian discovery pranayama controls the emotions by stimulating the para-sympathetic nervous system

Dr. Ali Bin Md Nadzalan, University of Pendidikan Sultan Idris, Malaysia and Dr. Zulezwan Bin Ab Malik, University of Pendidikan Sultan Idris, Malaysia, also spoke on the occasion.

Earlier, Dr. P. Sivakumar, Dean, Faculty of Education, Alagappa University, in his thematic address, said that neuro-education is an inter-disciplinary field that combines neuroscience, psychology and education to create improved teaching methods and curriculum and neuro-education is becoming increasingly popular nowadays. Dr. K. Balasubramanian, Organizing Secretary, welcomed the gathering.

Prof. V. Balachandran

Registrar i/c.